

Open in app ↗

Sign up

Sign in

Medium

 Search Write

Content Strategy +

Web3 +

Social Media +

Content Creation +

Writing +

What's next in media after the clickbait era?



t2.world

Follow

5 min read · Nov 25, 2022



When Taylor Swift shared in November 2021 that a ten-minute version of her song 'All Too Well' existed, the response was, as expected, a tsunami of anticipation — nevermind that it was more than three times the length of an average song on Spotify.

All this simply leads us to ask: Is the internet and its infinite scroll losing its appeal, and are people now drawn to, or rediscovering, more comprehensive and longer content?

Falling social media engagement numbers aren't breaking news anymore, and people's fatigue with bite-sized content has long been a studied issue. We are now at a point where users want something more substantial.

Is the internet we've grown to love now 'dead'?

To say that we are in the death throes of the internet is a hyperbole. But one can still say that the lofty promises of independence, freedom, and creativity that clickbait social media promised us weren't fulfilled, leaving some people apathetic, indifferent, or even angry.

The Dead Internet theory goes so far as to proclaim that the world wide web has gone to its grave. It posits that aside from your Aunt that posts vacation photos and your former colleague sharing a baby shower photo album, the rest of the web is populated by bots and artificial intelligence creating content to get us to engage.

And for those who are usually attacked by bots and often encounter artificial followers, that may be partly true. But who can completely prove it anyway? Before he finally acquired Twitter, Elon Musk shared in a tweet that 90% of the comments on his tweets were bots or spam replies, significantly higher than the 5% Twitter officially said.

And then there are the troll farms on Facebook coming from places as far as East Asia, Eastern Europe, and Russia that spread disinformation and propaganda, attempting to influence elections, spread malware, or harass

users. If the internet isn't dead, then it might as well be because it doesn't look like fun anymore.



Photo by [iam_os](#)

A change of appetite for content

And because of all these, there is a growing hunger among internet users for platforms that are more independent, humane, truly social, and genuine.

This includes a hunger for more nourishing and substantial content whose goal isn't to “stop thumbs” — as one platform likes to describe attention-getting posts—but foster intelligent discussions, cultivate relevant information, and bring people together around a common subject.

“For the last decade the web has served up bite-sized information like cheap fast food,” describes Ted Gioia. “But the new web just might give us that nutritious gourmet meal we’ve been waiting for.”

Get t2.world's stories in your inbox

Join Medium for free to get updates from this writer.

Enter your email

Subscribe



Remember me for faster sign in

And perhaps the analogy of food is appropriate. For coffee drinkers, one might recall the rise of the third wave of coffee characterised by deeper storytelling that talked about the entire coffee drinking experience: from the farm to the bean, roasters and baristas, to places of origin and flavour profiles. The second wave of coffee focused more on the rise of popular coffee brands and cafes. While the first wave was all about convenience.

For Gioia, “It’s now clear to me that consumption of information on the Internet will evolve in a similar way. Even better, online music and the other arts will trend in the same direction.”

While a 15-minute version of a Beyonce track is unlikely, long-format, in-depth, and well-made content is within reach. And this return to humane values and creations is what people are craving for, now and more so in the future.

Create, select, and curate good content

This goes both ways. For content publishers, the challenge of a more mindful audience presents an opportunity to tell stories that people actually

want to read, not what you think will get more clicks, says marketing guy Michael Benner.

Meanwhile, readers should also take a more proactive role in curating the content they consume, eschewing clickbait and supporting thoughtfully produced content.

For us at t2, this is part of our mission as a decentralised publishing platform. According to Founder and CEO, Mengyao Han, “t2 stands for building deep relationships with ourselves, with each other, and revealing the humane side of information consumption: to nurture ourselves and the network, in a difficult but meaningfully better way, with genuine nutritious content.”

We do this at t2 by creating a platform promoting deep reading through carefully curated content, while at the same time, providing incentives to our readers, writers, and contributors to build and manage a truly social platform.

We capture the time our users spend reading to nurture better content, to fund our writers, and to build connections between all users — and we reward them for it.

Time to make a change

“Time is our ultimate value in our exploration of life,” says Mengyao.

“Recognizing time’s value is recognizing ourselves. And take media as a garden to be nurtured and eventually nurture us back, not a plastic decoration shop we drop by once per year at Christmas. Because we do need

to have a long-term plan for deciding how to co-live and mutually benefit with the net.”

And in order to do that, the internet and its platforms must benefit all, not just a select few, while providing nourishing content worthy of people's attention.

. . .

Written by Peter Imbong, content creator at t2.

. . .

About T2

At t2 (time²), we are building a transparent, decentralized, and collaborative social network around reading and writing. We capture the time you spend reading to cultivate better content, align incentives, and empower content-driven communities.

Connect with us: [Website](#) | [Twitter](#) | [Discord](#) | [Newsletter](#)

Reading pays you back.

Content Strategy +

Web3 +

Social Media +

Content Creation +

Writing +



Written by t2.world

Follow

94 followers · 2 following

At t2 (time²), we are building a transparent, decentralized, and collaborative social network around reading and writing.

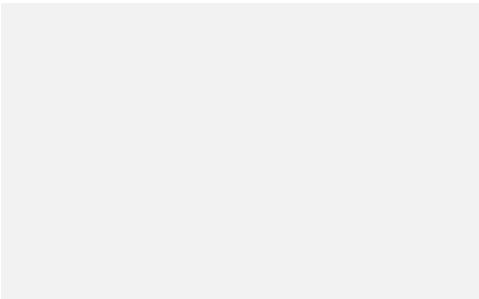
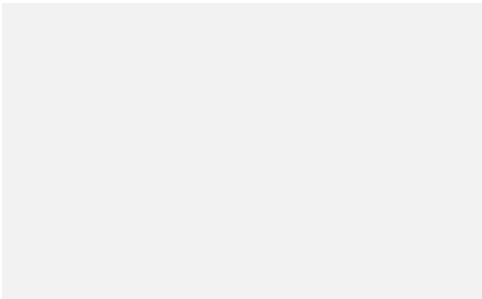


Placeholder for a bio or short text.

Placeholder for a list of items or a paragraph of text.

Placeholder for a line of text.

Placeholder for a line of text.



Placeholder for a line of text.

